

Game Development 1

Fall 2025 – Dylan Fries (Instructor)

Assignment 1: History of game development

Assignment Overview:

This assignment will be a research project, reflecting on the history of game development. You will start with a game you enjoy, modern or historical, then explore its history or legacy in game development.

You can choose to do Either Task A, or Task B, you don't have to do both.

Task A Details:

In Figma, you will expand out its "Family Tree" to include 15 – 20 different games related to it.

For each game, include a summary (couple of sentences) on why this game was significant, a screenshot, and the cover art (or concept/promotional art).

You could either trace a particular lineage of games (e.g. Command and Conquer, Warcraft, StarCraft) or trace a particular feature (e.g. Health Packs) or genre (e.g. Evolution of platformers or stealth games).

You could also either start with your selected game and trace the history of games that influenced it, or trace which games it influenced, or both.

Task B Details:

Research a game you enjoy and write a short essay discussing the how it was influenced by games that came before it, and/or how it influenced games that followed and why. You should really focus in on ONE key mechanic or element for an essay of this size. Some suggested points of reference could include the controls, gameplay, graphics, audio, technical features, story and design philosophy.

Deliverables:

- a. Provide a historical "family tree" graphic that lists and describes at least (minimum) 10 games that would be considered "influences" of the game you researched and/or include games that are influenced by the game you chose. (They don't have to be as developed as in Task A though)
- b. Include a 1-2 page mini-essay describing how the game concepts evolved and improved over time.

Assignment Length: 2 weeks